



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

AUG 2018

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for September is
August 17

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
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About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011



August

SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:30 am Worship with band and vocals.

(Outside, weather permitting)

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in August

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Notes: <i>The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.</i>			1 4p Eagle Scout Ceremony 5p Methodicals 7p Children's Council	2 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 5p Youth Potluck @ Nokomis Beach	3 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 1p June Swenson Memorial 5p Wedding Rehearsal 6:30p RCA	4 8:45a Brighter Minds Music 11a Wedding set up 3p Wedding
5 International Friendship Day Communion 6a Joy Catering 10:30a Worship at the falls 7p SAA	6 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	7 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	8 5p Methodicals	9 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	10 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	11 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
12 6a Joy Catering 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	13 International Left-Handers Day 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	14 7a Primary Elections 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 10:30a Staff Meeting 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	15 5p Methodicals 6p Toastmasters 6:30p Youth Sundaes and Games	16 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	17 Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	18 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
19 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 7p SAA	20 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	21 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	22 5p Methodicals	23 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	24 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	25 7a MinneHarvest 8:45a Brighter Minds Music
26 9a Worship with Organ 10:30a Worship with Band 3p Youth Group 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	27 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 3p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts	28 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	29 5p Methodicals 5:30p Faith Formation Preschool Open House	30 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	31 10a Al-Anon 10:30a Brighter Minds 6:30p RCA	Notes:

Worship in August

We begin our month with the annual *Worship at the Falls*. On August 5, we'll be at Minnehaha Falls Park at 10:30 for worship in the bandsbell. And we end the month with our annual *Animal Blessing* – all pets are welcome at the 10:30 outdoor service. See you in worship!

5th	Worship at the Falls, 10:30	
12th	"Living Bread?"	John 6:35, 41-51
19th	"The Birthday Present"	Mark 6:14-29
	<i>Becky on vacation; Valerie Mayer preaching</i>	
26th	"A New Covenant"	
	<i>Animal Blessing</i>	

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- Sept. 30 – Confirmation Sunday
- Oct. 7 – World Communion Sunday
- Oct. 12 – Monthly Taizé services begin
- Oct. 27 – Harvest Dinner (tentative date)
- Nov. 4 – All Saints Day
- Nov. 10 – Bazaar
- Nov. 21 – Ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve Service
- Dec. 1 – Advent Party



When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop by to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

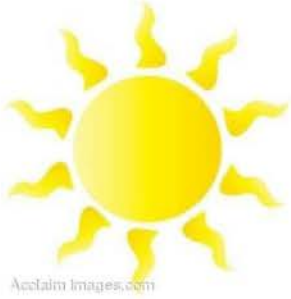
RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

August 17



Summer Youth Events



We look forward to seeing you at these events:

Thursday, August 2
Swimming, playing, potluck
at Nokomis Beach
5:00-9:00

All families of youth are invited to come for a relaxing evening at Nokomis Beach. Bring your own main dish and a side to share. We're trying to make this as simple as possible, so please also bring your own plates, silverware, and drinks. We'll gather in a picnic area (just look for Becky or people from church to see where we were able to set up), and you are welcome to swim (the beach has a lifeguard until 7:00), hang out, play games. Bring a lawn chair, any games you want to play, and your hammock if you just want to hang out. Rain location: Meet at the church. No swimming, but we can still eat, hang out, and play games.

Wednesday, August 15
Sundaes and Games
at church
6:30-8:30

We'll have ice cream and toppings, so come anytime for a time to play games and eat ice cream together.

Sunday, August 26
Youth Games & Ideas
at church
3:00-4:30

This is the kick off to our new year! We'll play games, get to know all the new youth joining the program, and start talking about what kinds of things we want to do together in the coming year.

Sunday, September 9
Rally Day
at church
9:00-12:00 and 3:00-4:30

The Youth with the Youth Council serve lunch after the worship service. Set up begins at 9:00, and serving will begin at 11:00. This is a fundraising for the youth program, so please come for as much of the morning as you can.

The afternoon continues our regular weekly youth programming. Youth will gather in the gym for games, and there will be an orientation for parents up in the youth room.



Children's Ministries

Way back in June, as summer began, we welcomed eighty children, youth, and adults into our building for our week of summer camps. For those of us lucky enough to spend the week in the building, it was inspiring and uplifting. Music & Drama Campers eagerly and enthusiastically learned about people throughout history who've done amazing things, and worked together to put on an incredible show: *Stories of Extraordinary People*. The songs that were stuck in their heads (and went home to be stuck in parents' head) all pointed to the same theme: what we do as individuals matters.

Kids attending VBS, *Rolling River Rampage*, heard stories, songs, and did activities celebrating the wonder and adventure of this life, and all involved were reminded continuously what it means to be a part of a team, supporting each other as we follow the call to spread God's love: what we do as a community matters.

As summer has hurried along, we've enjoyed worshipping together – hearing faith stories, serving together at Feed My Starving Children, visiting the Somali Museum, exploring neighborhood parks with the Minnehaha Playgroup, and gathering for picnics – at Minnehaha and beyond. We've seen our garden grow and tasted chives and tomatoes fresh from the garden (always feel free to help yourself), and wondered at how tall sunflowers can grow. Eighteen children and youth attended camp at Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds – some for Teddy Bear Camp and some for Trailblazers. Our campers enjoyed swimming, playing on the Wibit (an inflatable playstructure on the lake), boat rides, hikes, songs, games, archery, arts & crafts, wilderness survival training, sign language training, time with old friends and new friends, and learning from the wonderful staff

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We Celebrate!

We're thrilled to announce that we've hired a new Child Care Attendant for Sunday mornings at Minnehaha. **Alexandra Gaetan will be starting in the nursery on Sunday, 19th August.** She'll be available to watch children five and younger from 8:45 to 10:15am through the summer, and 8:45am-12:15pm during the program year. Stop by and meet Alexandra, and welcome her to Minnehaha.

Some tidbits about Alexandra: Her favorite colors are pink and purple, and her favorite animals are tigers and butterflies. She loves going on walks, has a seven-month-old, and is excited to be working with the little ones at Minnehaha.



Animal Blessing

Animals play an important role in many of our lives. If you have a special pet, we invite you to bring it to our annual animal blessing service on Sunday, August 26 at the 10:30 service (outside). We'll gather inside if it is raining, but either way, there will be a time in the worship service to have your pet blessed. Whether you have a horse or a hamster, bring them to church. Just make sure it's in a crate or container or on leash of some kind. If you don't have a pet, but wish you did, come anyway, and bring a stuffed animal if you'd like. If your pet doesn't like crowds, other animals, or can't really get out, bring a picture and we'll bless that. You may also wish to recognize the death of a pet in this way. And, invite your friends to bring their pets as well; we welcome everyone.



What: Faith Formation Preschool Open House

When: Wednesday, 29th August; 5:30-7pm

Where: Preschool Room (rm. 202) at Minnehaha

Who: All Families with Preschool Age (3 & 4 year olds) Children for the 2018-2019 Program Year

What: A chance to visit the Sunday School space and to learn about our Faith Formation programs.

At Minnehaha, we strive to help children develop curiosity about their faith, and to give them opportunities to seek, serve, and celebrate God's love in an intergenerational and inclusive setting.

**Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417
www.minnehaha.org, 612.721.6231**

Questions? Contact Jenia Strom, Director of Children & Family Ministries at education@minnehaha.org

Worship and Picnic at the Falls

On Sunday, August 5 we will be joining with other congregations in our neighborhood for a worship service at Minnehaha Falls Park. The service will be held at the bandshell and will begin at 10:30.

Following the service, we will be gathering for our last potluck garden party of the season with our neighbors. The potluck will be progressive style, with each congregation bringing a category of items. Hope Lutheran is providing smoked turkey, and we are in charge of desserts. So bring some desserts to share and we'll join with our neighbors at the shaded picnic area behind the bandshell for continued conversation and laughter.

(Continued from page 5)

of Camp Minnehaha. What we do with as a church matters.

It's been a full and good summer at Minnehaha, and while we still have a full month left, we've started pulling out calendars and beginning plans for a new program year. Rally Day is just a little over a month away. Autumn will begin. Life moves forward, and we do our best to keep up, and even lead when we can. As a church, we will do our very best to help children and families feel safe at Minnehaha – to have the love and support they receive be a constant amidst the changes and challenges of life. We will do our very best to help children and families feel empowered at Minnehaha – to be given the tools and space they need to do the transforming work of Christ in this very needy world of ours. We will do our very best to help children and families feel valued at Minnehaha – not in response to any accomplishment or contribution, but because simply and profoundly we are all children of God.

What we do matters, so what can we do as individuals and church community to bring God's peace to this world of ours? We hope to see you at Minnehaha as we continue to do our best to tackle this question in tangible ways.

Happy Summer,

Jenia Strom

Director of Children & Family Ministries



One Service Sundays

We will be having one service on two upcoming Sundays:

September 2 – one service inside at 10:00. Labor Day Weekend.

September 9 – one service outside at 10:00 for our program year kick-off. There will be food for sale, a bike parade, music, and other fun events following the service.



United Methodist Women

Families Moving Forward at Lake Nokomis Lutheran will be hosting families the week of Aug. 5-12. Volunteers are needed to help feed the families and provide evening activities. Please contact Maureen Trepp if you are interested in helping out.

We will be serving a meal at Simpson Shelter on Wed., Aug. 29. Volunteers can come directly to Simpson, at 28th St. and 1st Ave. or meet at church to carpool at 5:15. We serve between 5:30 and 8:30 and also need help in preparing the meal beforehand. Please let Maureen Trepp (612-724-7620) know if you can help or if you wish to help in the future.



MinneHarvest

One out of six Minnesotans goes hungry on a regular basis. Our free food give-away once a month is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us this month on Saturday, August 25. You can volunteer anytime between 7:00 and 10:30 a.m. We unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 8:30, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us, and bring a friend!

Solar Committee Update

We have had tremendous support from the MUMC community for solar energy! Thanks to those who supported the Solar Committee with their votes and also to those who put forth contributions to the cause. The final stages of financing are underway and solar panels have been ordered! The Solar Committee continues to engage with our partners to ensure that the project moves forward smoothly, and we expect the system will be up and running no later than October 31st, 2018. We will be providing regular updates in the upcoming weeks as more visible signs of the solar installation project get underway. Questions can be emailed to Chris Kramer at chriskramcrpt@gmail.com.

The Solar Committee is excited to see Minnehaha move into a future of greater environmental stewardship!

July 2018 Solar Project Dashboard

	Scope
	Schedule
	Budget

Blessing of Bags and Backpacks

We will be blessing bags and backpacks at our worship service on August 19. We are collecting back-to-school items for our MinneHarvest clients, and we want to give those backpacks a blessing in addition to any backpacks and bags of your own at the same time, so bring your back-to-school backpacks, your messenger bags, your purse, whatever you use to carry stuff, and we'll make sure it gets blessed!

Communion at Nokomis Square

A brief service of communion is offered at Nokomis Square on the second Thursday of this month. All are welcome to join us on August 9 at 1:00 p.m.



Sneak Preview of Fall Adult Classes

This fall, there will be two adult classes offered during the week.

***Harry Potter* – Monday evenings, 6:30-8:00 Sept. 10 – Oct. 22**

In conjunction with the sermon series, we'll read each of the books in the Harry Potter series, discussing their contents and the themes from the sermon the day before. If it's been awhile since you last read this series, you may want to re-acclimate yourself with them, and if you haven't read them before, you may want to start now since some of the books are quite long.

***The Scandalous Gospel of Jesus* – Thursday mornings, 10-11:30 Sept. 13 – Oct. 25**

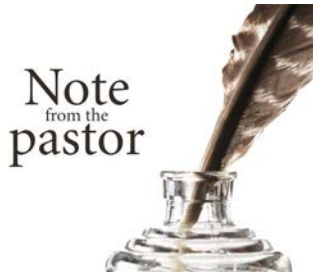
The late Peter Gomes was a professor, author, and longtime chaplain of the Harvard Memorial Chapel. In *The Scandalous Gospel*, he takes the church to task for focusing more on doctrines and rigid teachings than what Jesus actually had to say. The book is focused on helping the reader to encounter Jesus more directly, and ascertain what Jesus would have me to, *today*. The book can be found online through Cokesbury (or Amazon), or can be easily ordered through your favorite bookstore. We'll start with chapter 1 on Sept. 13.

Who is My Neighbor Ministry Announcement:

The Minnehaha gathering at the Daud Diner, for a delicious Somali meal and wonderful conversation together, has been rescheduled for

Lunch following worship on Sunday, 12th August

We hope to see you there. If you have any questions, please contact Beth Minehart or Ellis Rausch.



Baby Squirrels

We have baby squirrels at our house. Well, by now they are more teenage squirrels, but when we first noticed them this May, they were baby squirrels. Five of them, with their nest in one of our front yard trees, they would run along the fence and play in our back yard. When Martha and I left for renewal leave, our housemate, Janet, got to see them a lot. She said it was the best kitty TV ever! She would sit out in the back yard and knit or read, and the cats would hover near a bush or next to a tree and watch as the squirrels scampered along the fence, up and down the tree, and across the roofs of our house and garage. Every once in a while, one of the squirrels would get careless and one of the cats would try to catch it, but so far, the squirrels have remained just out of reach.

But then things changed. We came home, and we brought the dogs home as well. Now there were the work and play patterns of 3 people, not just one person, coming through the yard. Plus, the dogs wouldn't wait for the squirrels to actually get down onto the grass before charging at them and barking, chasing them back up the tree or along the fence line. The squirrels are having a hard time adjusting. Some days, they forget about the changes in "their" yard, and the dogs come within an inch or so of catching one of them.

It's like this for us, too. Changes come, and we are not always quick in adapting. We know God is always present, but we have our routines, and an interruption or change in that routine can get in the way of our spiritual life.

A new neighbor moves in, and now there is the sound of a loud lawnmower early on Saturday morning, which used to be the time you set aside for quiet reflection while sitting out on your patio.

Your children used to have an afternoon nap, and you used that time to read a psalm or pray for situations around the world. But your oldest has outgrown their nap time, and you find that your "time apart" is now filled with a child who wants to be entertained.

You had a good friend who was your go-to for theological reflection and wondering about God in the world. But s/he had to move away. And, yes, you can still call or text, but it isn't the same as getting together in person.

Your family has gone away to the same place for years. But they were sold to new management, and now "your" cabin has been razed, and new vacation townhomes are being built in its place.

You can make your own list of how your life has changed, because life is always changing. We change, and the world changes around us. The ways in which we reliably saw God and encountered God change. Thankfully, God is also in the new places, and in the new routines, but we have to find where; we have to adapt.

Soon it will be fall, and those teenaged squirrels in my yard will be young adult squirrels. They'll need to make their own nests, store up their own food, and figure out how to keep out of the stomachs of not only my dogs, but the bald eagles, red-tailed hawks, and foxes that I see regularly within a block of our house. They will continue to need to adapt. And, so will we. The prophet Isaiah hears God say, "I am about to do a new thing." Since God is always doing a new thing, we will always have new and different ways to encounter the living God.

In Joy,
Becky





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8/18

A decorative pennant banner runs diagonally across the lower half of the page. It consists of several triangular flags in orange, yellow, red, and blue with various patterns like polka dots and plaid.

37th AVENUE WILL BE CLOSED
between 50th Street & 51st Street
from 10:00am to 1pm

Minnehaha UMC
Rally Day:
Sunday, 9th
September 2018

Join with members of the Minnehaha United Methodist Church community as we celebrate the beginning of a new program year.

One Worship Service Outside at 10am
Followed by:

- Meeting & Greeting Sunday School Teachers
- A bike parade and lawn games
- All-Church Lunch

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